

Sunday, 23 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

23° 15°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

22° 12°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

21° 11°

GLASGOW

Overcast

18° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **Heartbreaking news from West Sussex, as a six-year-old girl has become the fourth member of her family to die after getting into difficulty in the sea.**

Saja El-Khawas passed away after the tragic incident off Shoreham. Her family members also lost their lives, prompting a police investigation into what happened.

TRAGEDY · UK

- 2 **A murder investigation has been launched after a body was discovered in a park following a wildfire.**

Police began their probe after the blaze revealed human remains. A post-mortem examination suggests the body belonged to a woman aged between 25 and 45.

CRIME · UK

- 3 **An Arran ferry had to be evacuated yesterday after a passenger, who had just been rescued from the sea, made a bomb threat.**

Police Scotland arrested a 23-year-old man, but later confirmed that the threats were not credible. It certainly caused a lot of alarm for those on board.

INCIDENT · UK

- 4 **Many students are now planning to live at home for university, with 'insane' living costs making campus life unaffordable for some.**

With accommodation and general living expenses soaring, students are facing tough choices. They worry about missing out on the full university experience, but feel they have no other option.

EDUCATION · UK

- 5 **Seven people, including two police officers, have died after a car travelling the wrong way on the A66 in Teesside collided with an oncoming police vehicle.**

It's a truly devastating incident on one of our major roads. Our thoughts are with all those affected by this terrible crash.

ACCIDENT · UK

What's coming up

1

Could Meghan, the Duchess of Sussex, be making a return to acting? Reports suggest she's in talks for a role in a Netflix series!

It's understood Meghan is discussing a part in 'The Gentlemen'. This would be her first significant acting gig since marrying Prince Harry.

ON AIR – Would you be excited to see Meghan back on screen? What kind of roles do you think she'd be brilliant in?
TV · FUTURE

2

Good news for gamers and action fans, as Dave Bautista has been confirmed as the new star of the 'God of War' adaptation!

The former wrestler will take over the role of Kratos in the upcoming series, based on the hugely popular PlayStation game. He's replacing Ryan Hurst.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of the 'God of War' games? Do you think Dave Bautista is a good choice to play Kratos?
FILM · FUTURE

3

Music lovers, get ready! Reading Festival kicks off next week, promising a huge weekend of live music.

The festival runs from Thursday 27th to Sunday 30th August. If you're heading there, it's always a good idea to plan your travel and accommodation in advance.

ON AIR – Are you going to Reading Festival? Who are you most excited to see performing live?
MUSIC · NEXT WEEK

4

The highly anticipated video game 'GTA 6' has seen clips appear online, sparking discussion about whether leaks will hurt its release.

Fans have been eagerly awaiting any news about the new Grand Theft Auto game. These leaks have certainly got people talking, for better or worse.

ON AIR – Do you think game leaks spoil the excitement, or do they just build more hype? What's your take?
GAMING · FUTURE

5

Musical icon Angélique Kidjo has made history with her Hollywood Walk of Fame star, dedicating it to Africa.

The Benin-born singer spoke about the importance of Africa and its people to music, saying 'This star is for Africa'. A wonderful moment for her and the continent.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Angélique Kidjo song? She's such an incredible talent!
AWARDS · RECENT

On the schedule

- 1 Arsenal have started their Premier League title defence in style, with a comfortable 3-0 win over newcomers Coventry City.**

Goals from Kai Havertz, Bukayo Saka, and Martin Odegaard secured the victory at the Emirates. It's a strong start for the champions on the opening day of the season.

ON AIR – Arsenal fans, how are you feeling after that opening win? Does it give you confidence for the season ahead?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 England have secured a huge innings victory against Pakistan in the first Test at Headingley, taking a 1-0 lead in the series!**

Jofra Archer took the final wicket as England bowled Pakistan out for 135. It was an emphatic performance, winning by an innings and 103 runs.

ON AIR – What did you make of England's performance in that first Test? Who was your player of the match?

CRICKET · UK
- 3 George Russell has claimed victory in the Dutch Grand Prix sprint race, leading from start to finish!**

The Mercedes driver had a fantastic race, winning from pole position. It's a great result for Russell and sets him up well for the main race.

ON AIR – F1 fans, how impressed were you with George Russell's sprint race win? Can he carry that momentum into the main event?

F1 · INTERNATIONAL
- 4 Hull City pulled off a stunning upset against Manchester United in the Premier League, with Ajayi being a rock at the back!**

It was a fantastic performance from Hull, shocking one of the league's big teams. Ajayi's defensive display earned him high praise in the player ratings.

ON AIR – Were you surprised by Hull's victory over Man Utd? What a result for them!

FOOTBALL · UK
- 5 Tottenham are shaping up under new manager Roberto De Zerbi, who has had time and money to build a new-look squad this summer.**

Fans will be keen to see how the team performs with De Zerbi's influence. It's an exciting time for Spurs supporters hoping for a strong season.

ON AIR – Spurs fans, how do you feel about the changes under De Zerbi? Are you optimistic for the season ahead?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study reveals that simply looking at photos of nature can reduce stress levels.**
Even a quick glance at lush landscapes or tranquil seascapes can have a calming effect, proving nature's power even in digital form.
- 2 The charm of 'upcycling old furniture' is growing, with more people transforming pre-loved pieces.**
This creative trend is not only sustainable but also allows for unique, personalised home decor that tells a story.
- 3 Experts suggest that 'learning a new language' can significantly boost cognitive function at any age.**
Beyond travel, the mental workout of mastering new vocabulary and grammar keeps the brain agile and sharp.
- 4 The simple pleasure of 'picnicking in local parks' is experiencing a delightful comeback this summer.**
Families and friends are rediscovering the joy of al fresco dining, armed with blankets, sandwiches, and good company.
- 5 A fascinating report highlights the rise of 'community-run cinemas' bringing classic films to local halls.**
These volunteer-led initiatives are creating vibrant social hubs and a nostalgic experience away from commercial multiplexes.
- 6 Research indicates that 'listening to audiobooks' can enhance empathy and imagination.**
Engaging with stories through sound allows listeners to visualise scenes and characters in their own unique way, fostering creativity.
- 7 The delightful art of 'collecting vintage postcards' is finding a new generation of enthusiasts.**
Each card offers a tiny window into the past, sharing greetings and snapshots from bygone eras and faraway places.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a kettle has truly boiled, without actually looking inside? What is it?

ANSWER: HUMMING A LITTLE TUNE TO OURSELVES WHILE WE WAIT, PRETENDING WE'RE NOT WAITING!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh glass of water from the tap. What is it?

ANSWER: RUNNING THE TAP FOR A 'JUST RIGHT' AMOUNT OF TIME, EVEN IF IT'S PERFECTLY COLD ALREADY!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of weather' just makes you feel incredibly happy or reflective? What's that weather condition that just instantly lifts your spirits, or makes you feel wonderfully calm, and why?
- We all have those 'little everyday sounds' that bring us a surprising amount of comfort or joy, don't we? From the gentle purr of a cat to the distant whistle of a train, what everyday sound brings a smile to your face?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that an octopus has three hearts and can also change its skin colour to match its emotions?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£50 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£50 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's oldest known living tree is Methuselah, a bristlecone pine in California, estimated to be over 4,800 years old.
- A 'floccinaucinihilipilification' is the act of estimating something as worthless.
- The average cloud weighs around 550 tons, roughly the same as 100 elephants.
- Britain's highest point, Ben Nevis, receives around 260 days of rain and snow a year.
- More people visit France than any other country in the world.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'Go.'
- There are more fake flamingos in the world than real ones.
- The 'tear' in tear gas actually refers to a chemical compound, not emotional tears.

On this day

Day 235 of the year, 130 days left in 2026. Today Battle of Kursk Day (Russia); Christian feast day: Ascelina; Christian feast day: Asterius, Claudius, and Neon; Christian feast day: Éogan of Ardstraw. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — Lianne La Havas, British singer, songwriter, and multi-instrumentalist
- 1974 — Ray Park, Scottish actor and stuntman
- 1981 — Jaime Lee Kirchner, American actress
- 1959 — Edwyn Collins, Scottish singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1947 — David Robb, Scottish actor
- 1928 — Marian Seldes, American actress (died 2014)
- 1947 — Linda Thompson, English folk-rock singer-songwriter
- 1986 — Ayron Jones, American musician

THE DAY TODAY

- 1966 — Lunar Orbiter 1 takes the first photograph of Earth from orbit around the Moon.
- 2007 — The skeletal remains of Russia's last royal family members Alexei Nikolaevich, Tsarevich of Russia, and his sister Grand Duchess Anastasia are discovered near Yekaterinburg, Russia.
- 2012 — A hot-air balloon crashes near the Slovenian capital of Ljubljana, killing six people and injuring 28 others.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1975 — The start of the Wave Hill walk-off by Gurindji people in Australia, lasting eight years, a landmark event in the history of Indigenous land rights in Australia, commemorated in a 1991 Paul Kelly song and an annual celebration.
- 2010 — The Manila hostage crisis occurred near the Quirino Grandstand in Manila, Philippines killing 9 people including the perpetrator while injuring 9 others.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2007 — The skeletal remains of Russia's last royal family members Alexei Nikolaevich, Tsarevich of Russia, and his sister Grand Duchess Anastasia are discovered near Yekaterinburg, Russia.
- 2023 — Chandrayaan-3 mission initiated first Moon landing in Indian history.

- 1985 — Hans Tiedge, top counter-spy of West Germany, defects to East Germany.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 236 of the year, 129 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aurea of Ostia; Christian feast day: Bartholomew the Apostle (Roman Catholic, Anglican); Christian feast day: Edward Klinik; Christian feast day: Emily de Vialar. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1965 — Marlee Matlin, American actress and producer
- 1940 — Madsen Pirie, British academic, President and co-founder of the Adam Smith Institute
- 1949 — Stephen Paulus, American composer and educator (died 2014)
- 1955 — Kevin Dunn, American actor
- 1973 — Carmine Giovinazzo, American actor
- 1945 — Ken Hensley, English rock singer-songwriter and musician (died 2020)
- 1945 — Ronee Blakley, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1947 — Anne Archer, American actress and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2020 — Erin O'Toole is elected leader of the Conservative Party of Canada.
- 2004 — Ninety passengers die after two airliners explode after flying out of Domodedovo International Airport, near Moscow. The explosions are caused by suicide bombers from Chechnya.
- 2006 — The International Astronomical Union (IAU) redefines the term "planet" such that Pluto is now considered a dwarf planet.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1991 — Ukraine declares itself independent from the Soviet Union.
- 2010 — In San Fernando, Tamaulipas, Mexico, 72 illegal immigrants are killed by Los Zetas and eventually found dead by Mexican authorities.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

22–23

Belgian Grand Prix (F1)